

Overview

Degeneration is a competitive 2 player game, where players take turns drafting the perfect round to take each other down. The game is won when one player kills all 3 of their opponent's characters.

Setup

Bans (*Optional, for experienced players*)

Player 1 picks one character to ban. That character cannot be played.

Then, Player 2 picks one character to ban. That character cannot be played

Drafting

Player 1 picks one character to join their team. Player 1 takes the associated character's cards and title card.

Then, Player 2 picks two characters to join their team. Player 2 takes the associated characters' cards and title card.

Then, Player 1 picks two characters to join their team. Player 1 takes the associated characters' cards and title card.

Finally, Player 2 picks one character to join their team. Player 2 takes the associated character's cards and title card.

Play Area

Both players create a deck using the cards of their chosen characters (18 cards per player), which is shuffled and placed face down. This constitutes the draw pile.

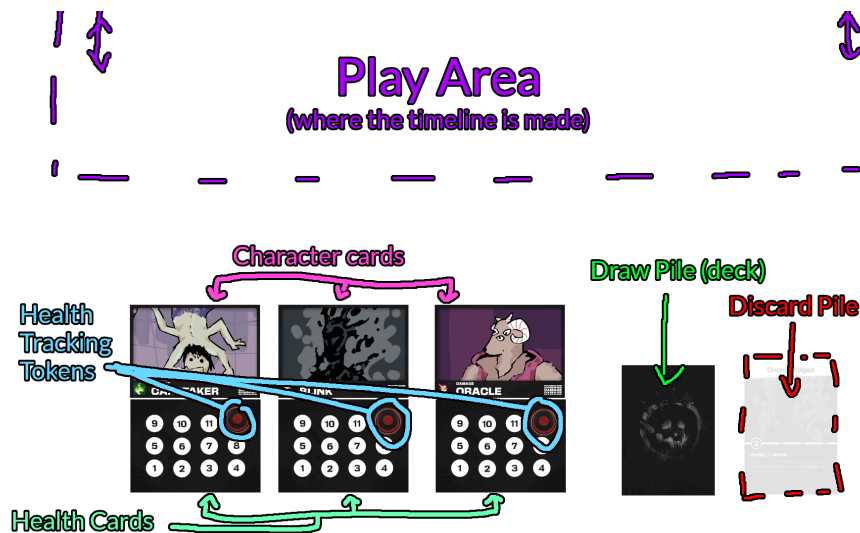
Both players lay out their character title cards and health cards: This is done by placing the character title card above a corresponding health card.

Then, place them side by side on each players' respective side of the field, and place a "Health Tracking Token" on the number '12' for each character's health card. This is used to track each characters' health.

Make sure there is enough space to place discarded cards, placed face up to distinguish it from the draw pile.

There are also 12 Judgement cards. Shuffle these cards and place them face down in a location accessible to both players. These will be used when a character dies (discussed later).

Once the game is set up, both players draw 6 cards into their hands. Congratulations, you're ready to play!



How each player should set up their side of the board. Note that the purple “Play Area” is shared by both players

Gameplay

Timeline/Card Placement

The game takes place on a ‘timeline’, made by both players using cards.

The first player can place any card they want, but subsequent cards must be played following certain rules regarding placement. These are:

Placement regarding speed: Cards will have a speed value of 0, 1, 2, 3, or 1|2. Speed 0 is the fastest, whilst Speed 3 is the slowest.

Cards that are faster **MUST** be placed before slower cards in the timeline, and vice versa (i.e. slower cards **MUST** be placed after faster cards). Cards can be placed before or after other cards of equal value, granted that they also follow the second placement rule (see “placement regarding space”).



A speed value of “1|2” means the card can be played or treated as if it has a speed of either 1 or 2. If placed first, or in an otherwise ambiguous setting (for example, a row of cards all with speed 1|2), the card is treated as having a speed of either 1 or 2 until another card played ‘contextualises’ the speed

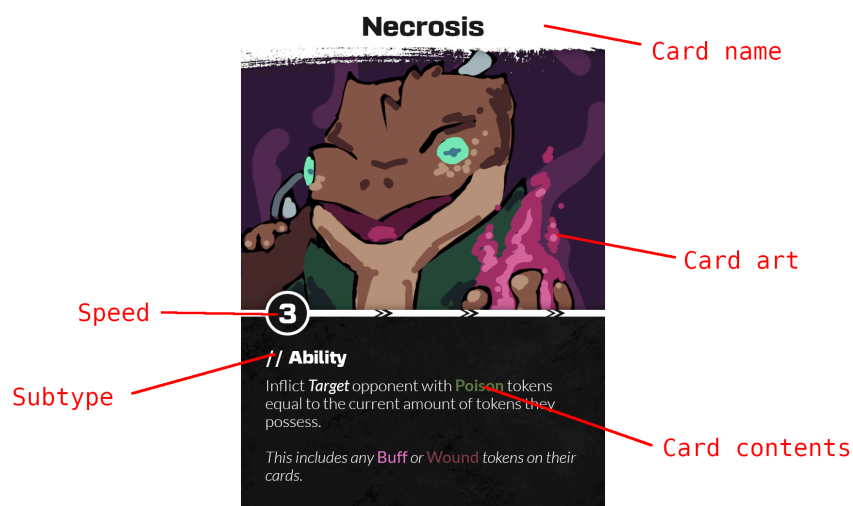
Example 1: A card of speed 2 is placed before a card of speed 1|2. This forces the 1|2 card to have 2 Speed.

Example 2: A card of speed 1 is placed after a card of speed 1|2. This forces the 1|2 card to have 1 Speed.

Placement regarding space: Cards can only be placed at the beginning or end of a timeline, and CANNOT be placed between already played cards. If it is your turn to play 2 cards, you can adjust how you position those 2 cards before ending your turn, but any confirmed placements CANNOT be altered.

Card Anatomy

A card consists of multiple components, laid out like so:



Card name: Name of the card

Card art: Art showcasing who is casting the card. Cards may refer to these characters as ‘casters’.

Speed: The speed of a card dictates its placement on the ‘timeline’. A speed of 0 is the fastest, a speed of 3 is the slowest.

Subtype: Can be Strike, Fortify or Ability. Cards can have up to 2 subtypes. Certain cards only affect other cards of a certain subtype, so read carefully!

Card contents: Describes the effects of a card. Only activates once it has been reached on the timeline.

Playing Turns/Rounds

Player 1 plays 1 card, putting it down on the shared playspace. It is now Player 2’s turn.

Player 2 plays 2 cards, placing them besides the initial card relative to their speed. It is now Player 1's turn. *Note that you can place both cards before or after the placed card.*

Player 1 plays 2 cards, placing them besides existing cards relative to their speed. It is now Player 2's turn. *Note that you can place both cards before or after the placed cards.*

Player 2 plays 1 card, placing it behind or in front of the entire timeline. Both players' turns are over.

At this point, all that's left is to play out the round in order, and resolve any relevant effects! Once everything has been resolved, both players place their played cards into their respective discard piles, and draw cards until they have 6 cards in hand.

Now, the process starts again, with the starting player alternating each round (i.e. if Player 2 went last, they go first this round, and vice-versa). This repeats until all characters on one side have been killed.

Discard/Mulligan (playing less than 3 cards)

A player may choose to skip their turn, or may be forced to skip their turn, playing less than 3 cards in a round. As soon as a player skips their turn, they discard their entire hand and forfeit their ability to play cards for the rest of the round.

Once the round concludes, they draw cards like normal, refilling their hand until they have 6 cards in hand.

Death

When a character dies, all their cards are immediately removed from the *timeline* (playspace) and their effects do NOT trigger. Cards CANNOT be placed to replace these cards. Any triggered cards with a persistent effect will be removed, and their persistent effect(s) will no longer trigger.

Once the round ends, remove all of their associated cards from your hand, discard pile and draw pile. Flip the Health Tracking card (skull side up) on top of the Character Title card to indicate their death. They are completely removed from play.

Place all removed cards on top of the flipped Health Tracking card. *These will be used to play **Judgement** cards*

Draw 2 **Judgement** cards per character that died, and put them in your draw pile.

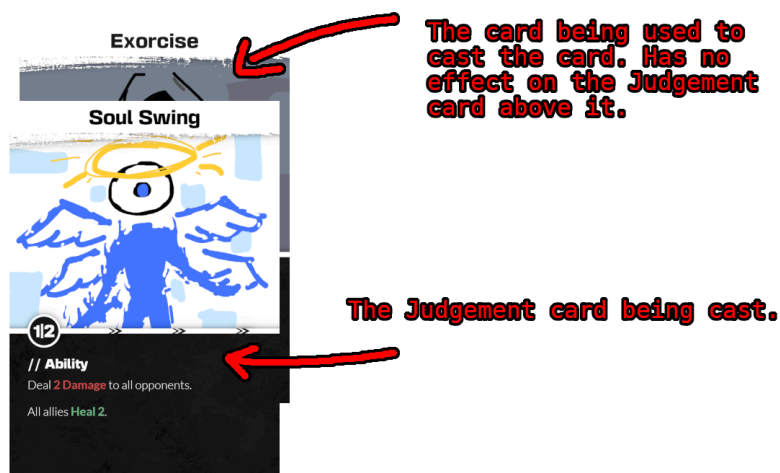
Shuffle your draw pile, then draw until you have 6 cards in hand.

If you have 1 dead ally, you should have 2 Judgement cards in your deck. If you have 2 dead allies, you should have 4 Judgement cards in your deck.

Judgement Cards

If a player has a judgement card in hand, they may play it with the card of a dead ally placed underneath. The dead ally will count as the caster, and their cards can be affected by Wound, Buff and Cleanse tokens (to remove Wound tokens), but they cannot take Damage, Heal, or receive Shield or Poison tokens.

At the end of the round, the Judgement card is placed in the discard pile, while the supporting card is removed from the game.



Once per round, a player may discard a Judgement card from hand, and draw a new one from the Judgement deck. Place the discarded card at the bottom of the Judgement deck, and place the drawn card in hand.

Glossary

Keywords

A list of keywords that may appear on a card, influencing how they play and resolve. This section, and its examples, should help clarify rules and disputes!

Damage: How much health is removed from a character. Shield tokens can be used to reduce damage equal to the shield tokens expended. Characters die when their health reaches 0 (refer to *Death* section).

Example 1: A character has 10 health, and receives 3 damage. That character now has 7 health.

Example 2: A character has 10 health, 2 Shield tokens, and receives 3 damage. The 2 Shield tokens block 2 damage, so the character only receives 1 damage to their health. That character now has 9 health.

Heal(s): How much health a character recovers. Characters may not exceed the maximum health pool of 12. Characters that receive excess healing instead heal up to their maximum health (12).

Example 1: A character has 8 health, and Heals 2. That character now has 10 health.

Example 2: A character has 8 health, and Heals 5. As characters have a maximum health pool of 12, that character now has 12 health, despite $8+5=13$.

Ally/Opponent: The contents of this card affects the specified group of characters. When playing a card, 'Ally' represents characters on your side of the board, i.e. characters

you picked during the drafting stage, while 'Opponent' represents characters on your opponent's side of the board, i.e. characters they picked during the drafting stage. 'All Allies' means the card affects all characters on your side of the board, and 'All Opponents' means the card affects all characters on your opponent's side of the board.

Target: When playing a card with the *target* keyword, you must immediately use a targeting token to declare the character being targeted. The targeting token chosen must respect other keywords, such as *ally/opponent* (i.e. '*target ally*' must target a character on your side of the board, and '*target opponent*' must target a character on your opponent's side of the board). The effects of the card only affect the target chosen, unless specified otherwise.

Example 1: A card reads "target opponent takes 2 damage". When placing this card down, you must immediately place a targeting token down on the card, targeting an opposing character. When the card is cast during the timeline, only that character takes 2 damage.

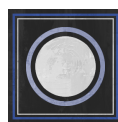
Example 2: A card reads "Target opponent takes 1 damage. Then, all opponents take 1 damage". When placing this card down, you must immediately place a targeting token down on the card, targeting an opposing character. When the card is cast during the timeline, it does 1 damage to the chosen character, and 1 damage to all opposing characters, i.e. the character that has been targeted takes 2 damage total (while everyone else takes 1).

Persistent: Once this card is triggered, for the rest of the timeline, all proceeding cards must follow an additional game rule as outlined by the keyword. The 'Persistent' trigger happens BEFORE the contents of a card, unless specified otherwise.

Example: A card reads "Persistent: Whenever someone casts a Fortify card, deal 1 damage to its caster". Once the card has been cast on the timeline, all following Fortify cards hurt their caster for 1 damage, before executing their original effects.

Tokens

Certain cards give characters tokens, strong temporary effects which can swing the outcome of a game. All tokens are removed when the round concludes, and are not carried over between rounds.

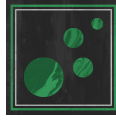


Shield: Whenever a character receives a **shield** token, that token is placed on their character card.

Whenever a character takes damage, if they have a **shield** token, they use it to negate incoming damage.

Example 1: A character has 10 health, 2 shield tokens, and takes 3 damage. That character now has 9 health, as they used 2 shield tokens to block 2 damage.

Example 2: A character has 10 health, 4 shield tokens, and takes 3 damage. That character uses 3 shield tokens to fully block the damage (they remain at 10 health), and has 1 shield token remaining. This token stays on the character until the end of the round, available to block other sources of incoming damage if necessary.



Poison: Whenever a character receives a **poison** token, that token is placed on their character card.

At the end of a round, **poison** tokens deal damage to the character they're attached to before being removed. This damage *cannot* be blocked by **shield** tokens. Damage is equal to **poison** tokens removed.

Example 1: A character ends the round with 10 health and 2 poison tokens. That character, after removing all tokens, instead ends the round with 8 health.

Example 2: A character ends the round with 10 health, 2 shield tokens and 2 poison tokens. That character, after removing all tokens, instead ends the round with 8 health, as shield tokens do not affect poison tokens.



Cleanse: Whenever a character receives a **cleanse** token, that token is placed on their character card.

Cleanse tokens can be used at any point during play (player's discretion) to remove **poison** tokens (from characters) or **wound** tokens (from cards). Note that cleanse tokens can only remove poison and wound tokens from the character with the token (and their cards), and cannot be used to remove **poison** or **wound** tokens from other characters.

Example 1: A character has 2 poison tokens on them. They receive 1 cleanse token. That character now has 1 poison token on them.

Example 2: A character has 2 poison tokens on them. They receive 3 cleanse tokens. That character now has no poison tokens, and 1 cleanse token remaining. This token stays on the character until the end of the round, available to block other sources of poison/wound if necessary

Example 3: A character has 2 poison tokens on them, and one of their cards is about to receive 1 wound token. However, earlier on in the round, they also received 1 cleanse token. Instead of using the 1 cleanse token immediately to remove 1 poison token, they decided to hold onto it instead, to negate the incoming wound token. That character still has 2 poison tokens, but now has no wound tokens on their card.



Wound: Whenever a card receives a **wound** token, that token is placed on the affected card, and belongs to the character casting that card. **Wound** tokens are removed at the end of the round, similar to **poison** tokens, or excess **shield/cleanse** tokens.

Wound tokens decrease all numerical values on a card by 1.

Example 1: A character's card reads "Deal 2 damage to target opponent". With 1 wound token attached, the card now reads "Deal 1 damage to target opponent".

Example 2: A character's card reads "Deal 2 damage to target opponent. Then, deal 2 damage to target opponent. Then, inflict 2 Poison tokens on target opponent". With 1 wound token attached, the card now reads "Deal 1 damage to target opponent. Then, deal 1 damage to target opponent. Then, inflict 1 Poison tokens on target opponent".

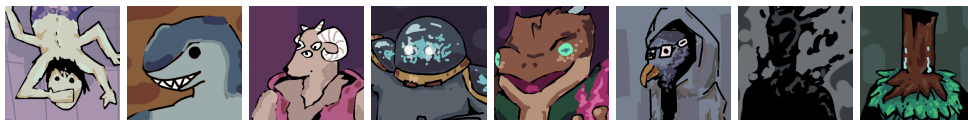


Buff: Whenever a card receives a **buff** token, that token is placed on the affected card, and belongs to the character casting that card. **Buff** tokens are removed at the end of the round, similar to **poison** tokens, or excess **shield/cleanse** tokens.

Buff tokens increase all numerical values on a card by 1.

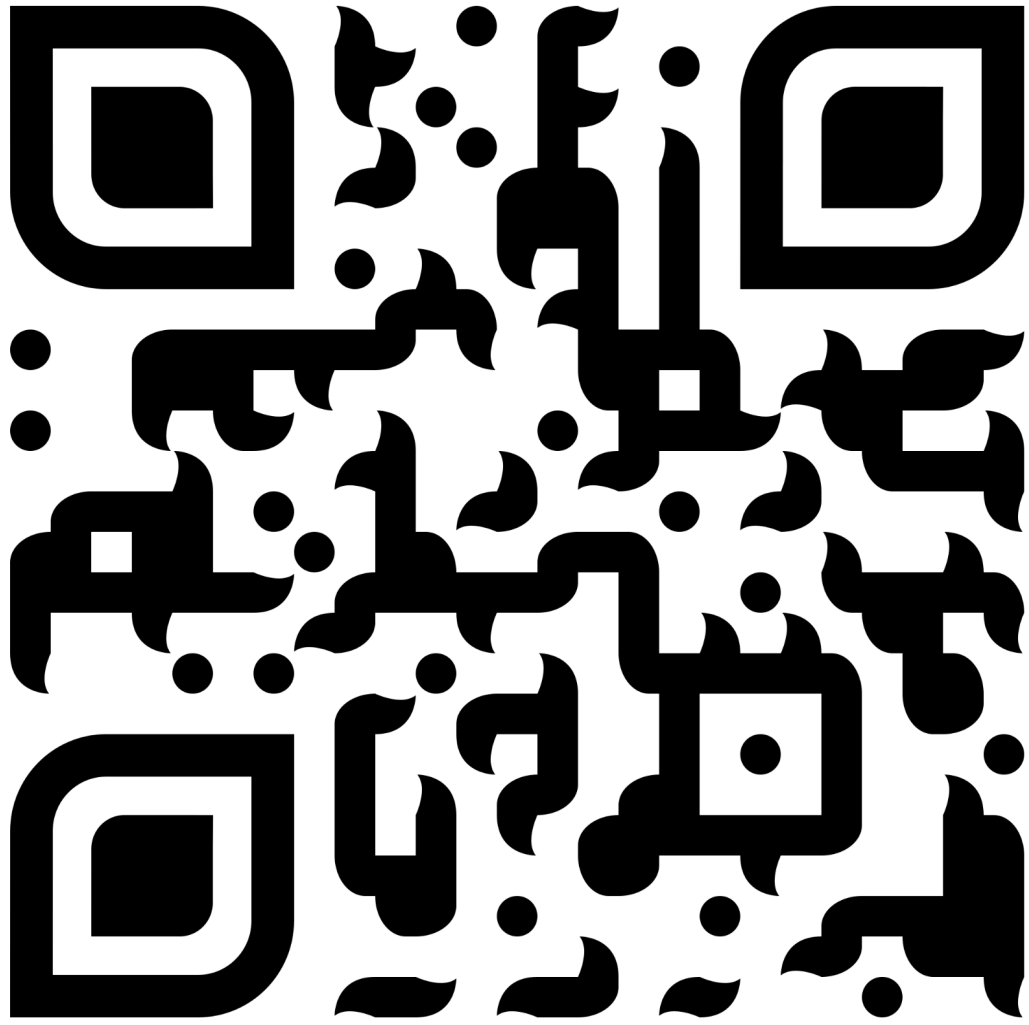
Example 1: A character's card reads "Deal 2 damage to target opponent". With 1 buff token attached, the card now reads "Deal 3 damage to target opponent".

Example 2: A character's card reads "Deal 2 damage to target opponent. Then, deal 2 damage to target opponent. Then, inflict 2 Poison tokens on target opponent". With 1 buff token attached, the card now reads "Deal 3 damage to target opponent. Then, deal 3 damage to target opponent. Then, inflict 3 Poison tokens on target opponent".



Targeting tokens: Tokens placed on cards to indicate which ally or opponent you are targeting. Used for cards with the '*target*' keyword.

These tokens are not affected by any effects targeting or manipulating tokens, only by effects that target or manipulate the '*target*' keyword.



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